

Karthik Malli

Curriculum Vitae

karthikmalli92@gmail.com — LinkedIn — GitHub

EDUCATION HISTORY

Masters in South Asian Studies

Graduate Certificate in Digital Textual Studies

University of Washington

2024 - 2026

My final papers examine the intersection of language, writing, and identity in India. I focus on script reform efforts in Indian languages triggered by the introduction of typewriters, and the development of linguistic nationalism in Kannada.

ACADEMIC AWARDS

Fellowships

Frank F Conlon Fellowship, 2024 - '25

\$7500

Scholarships

Indian American Community Services (IACS) scholarship, 2024 - '25

\$3500

Travel Grants

UW South Asia Center Travel Grant, '24

\$200

UW South Asia Center Travel Grant, '25

\$200

University of British Columbia, Conference Grant, '26

\$200

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

Script Encoding Initiative, UC Berkeley

June 2025 – Sept 2025

Research Intern

- Conducted secondary research on the relationship between writing technology, script, and modernity, with a focus on Indic writing systems such as Devanagari and Malayalam.
- Wrote a blog post titled *Typewriters, Script, and Modernity in India* on the institution website documenting my research findings and process, and my collaboration with the team.

Typotheque

July 2020 – Aug 2024

Research Consultant

- Analyzed the typographic evolution of Indian scripts through archival material and language policy documentation and conducted sociolinguistic research on preferences in writing system usage.
- Worked with type designers to guide the development of proprietary fonts for Devanagari, Malayalam, Urdu, and Meitei, and wrote detailed research reports narrating the typographic history and evolution of Devanagari, Malayalam, and Urdu.

Freelance

March 2019 – Aug 2024

Independent Researcher/Writer

- Wrote over 16 widely read essays in notable magazines and publications on language identity and history in India in collaboration with editors, academics, public figures, and community activists.
- Actively participated in public-facing scholarship by translating academic research into highly engaging and readable long form narrative writing.

PUBLICATIONS

Digital Humanities

Where Do Indian-Language Books at UW Come From? — GitHub

R, *Leaflet*.

Analyzed a dataset of over 11,000 Indian-language books in the UW library system to visualize books by language by year of publication, and publication location with cities weighted in color and size by book number.

Washington State Counties With Indigenous Language Names — GitHub

R, *Leaflet*.

Created an interactive map highlighting Washington state counties with names derived from Indigenous languages of the region, overlaid on county boundaries.

Selected Public Writing

Exploring Jotirao Phule's Place in Modern Marathi Literature

The Caravan, Oct '22

Victory City, essay on heritage and identity in Bijapur, Karnataka

fiftytwo.in, Jan '23

Girish Karnad & Karnataka's Multilingual Literary Heritage

Newslaundry, Jan '19

Dialect Variation In Tulu

Deccan Herald, Jan '20

PRESENTATIONS

Indic Script Policy & Planning in the Digital Age

Oct '24

Unicode Technical Workshop, *Unicode Consortium*

Malayalam Script Reform: Modernity and Technology

May '25

South Asia Center Graduate Symposium, *University of Washington*

Capturing Script Dynamism: The Indic Case

Nov '25

Unicode Technical Workshop, *Unicode Consortium*

Single File: Typewriters and Script Reform in Indian Language Planning

May '26

South Asia Conference of the Pacific Northwest, *University of British Columbia*

Mechanized Type and Modernity in Indian Literary Culture

May '26

South Asia Center Graduate Symposium, *University of Washington*

PROGRAMMING LANGUAGES & LIBRARIES

R (*dplyr*, *Leaflet*, *ggplot*), **Python** (*pandas*, *spaCy*, *Stanza*), **XML** (*TEI*).

NON-ENGLISH READING ABILITY

Hindi, Kannada, Tamil, Urdu, Malayalam.